

Palm Tungsten E

This entry-level business PDA is encased in a slick metal casing. Running Palm OS 5.2.1, the Tungsten E measures a mere 4.5 x 3.1 x 0.5 inches and weighs just 130 grams. It can easily be slipped into a jacket or shirt pocket.

The facia includes the 320 x 320 TFT screen, and the traditional silkscreen area. Under this, you find the rectangular five-way navigator with two application buttons on either side. The stylus is located in a partly covered silo, while the expansion card slot, IR port, stereo headphone jack and power switch are on top. The charging port and the USB cable connectors are at the bottom, and the speaker is at the back. The steel finish casing tapers inwards from both sides, goading the E into conference rooms.

For a business solution, this PDA has limited connectivity options. You only get the card expansion slot and infra-red; there's no Bluetooth or wireless capability. Also, Palm has done away with the Universal connector, and opted for a direct USB connection for PC synchronisation.

A charger and a USB cable, both of which connect directly to dedicated sockets at the bottom, come with the package. Playback of audio and video clips is supported by the

bundled software. MP3 playback requires an external memory card, though.

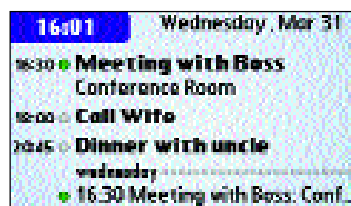
Standard PIM applications—calendar, contacts, and world clock—come pre-installed, and the calculator is installed at first HotSync. The Software Essentials CD includes Documents To Go, Palm Dialer, RealOne Mobile Player, Kinoma Player, and Palm Reader, apart from other useful applications.

The 126 MHz processor ensures smooth playback of audio and video. The audio quality from the integrated speaker is decent. Usability is excellent, and synchronising the device is a breeze. However, the rectangular five-way navigator requires that you use the tip of your thumb to scroll. Application buttons, too, lack depth. In our battery drain test using Kinoma player, the internal Lithium-ion polymer battery yielded two hours and five minutes of playtime before the device gave its first low battery warning, but it ran another 42 minutes before shutting off.

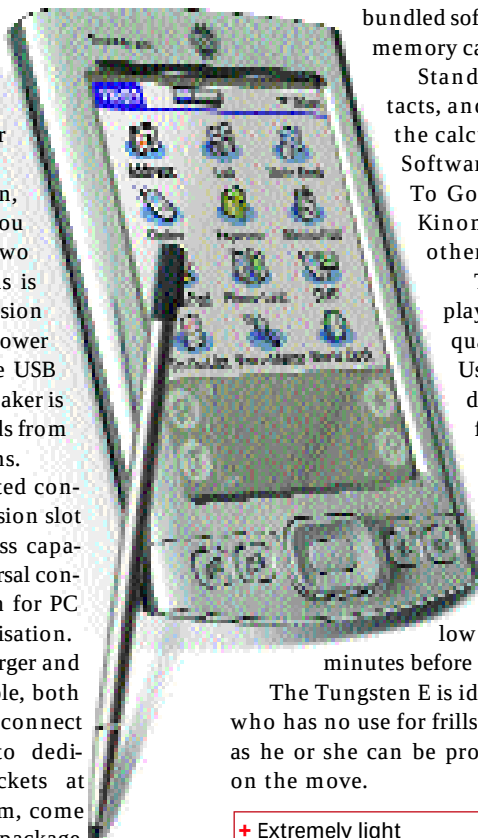
The Tungsten E is ideal for a budget-conscious business user who has no use for frills, so long as he or she can be productive on the move.

- + Extremely light
 - Lacks connectivity features
- Price:** Rs 13,999

Palm Tungsten E		B-
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶	
Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶	



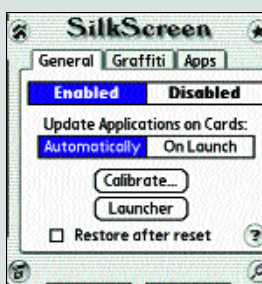
The Agenda screen displays appointments and tasks for the day



Change that Look

The Palm OS is flexible enough to allow for utilities that change the icons and the look of the interface. Some even change the way applications launch, suggest colour themes and backgrounds, and even provide battery status, alternate data input methods, etc. Do check compatibility with your device, and the Palm OS version, before you start experimenting, though!

One such utility, SilkScreen (www.rogame.com/pages/SilkScreen.html), serves as an application launcher and lets you perform all functions associated with the silkscreen in the main display. It reserves space at the four edges of the screen. Enable SilkScreen to use four virtual buttons that perform the same actions as the buttons in the graffiti area. You can also write in the main display area. A menu lets you access any installed application, or on the memory card. You can also check battery status and access the virtual keyboard, brightness, and so on.



Enhance your usage experience with your Palm device using SilkScreen

ZLauncher (www.zztechs.com/en/launcher.php4), lets you change backgrounds, colour schemes and fonts. It includes a theme manager, and a file manager that gives you access to all data stored on the device, or on the expansion card. Besides standard operations such as deleting, organising, copying and moving data, the file manager also lets you beam a file directly. You also get battery and memory status, a virtual power-off button and so on.

SilverScreen (<http://www.pocket-sensei.com/silverscreen.htm>) is another popular application launcher. It has a pop-up toolbar where you can drag and drop application icons or files to get info, categorise, beam, or delete them. You can assign two applications to hotspots, and get a list of recently-accessed applications.

Other interface enhancements include tab-based access to various categories of application, and a ticker that displays to-dos and appointments. Theme support is excellent, and you can customise almost everything, including application icons, fonts, battery status meter and even scroll bars.



ZLauncher changes the look and feel of your Palm device